



Hilfe, ich bin ein Mensch!

(Help, I'm a Human!)



Kayfab-Kings of Scientific

Human Nature-Wrestling

Take me to
your leader
(if he's nice)



DO NOT READ!
CUT IMMEDIATELY!

Contains traces of
Empathy &
7% Psychopaths

THE LIE



We were told life is a war.
We were told we are selfish beasts.
This is the Old Kayfabe. It is BLÖDSINN. Kayfabe: Staged reality. BLÖDSINN: Nonsense!

THE TRUTH



Science says we are the "Friendliest."
We survive by hugging, not hitting.
Use these cards to rewrite the story. Friendliest: Our secret weapon. Hug it out!

THE SCISSORS



Destroy this PDF. Cut the cards.
Shuffle. Play as Actors. Build the
Stage. Fix the Worldview.

Rebel tech.
No more suits.
Hack the rules!

THE QUEST DIE



1 = Isolation/Freeze. 6 = Chaos/Explosion. Roll with it.
Keep the story in the flow (3-4). Find the balance.
If it tips... KAYFA-BOOM! Kayfa-boom: Story exploded

CHARLES DARWIN

Snip
snip!



STATS:

[R] High | [A] Med | [F] Low

POWER:

Sympathy Instinct:
Play to cancel a
"Selfish" action.

LORE:

Sympathy will have
been increased through
natural selection.
(Ref: Darwin)

THE SELFISH GENE

Snip
snip!



STATS:

[R] Low | [A] High | [F] High

POWER:

Ego Boost: Gain
control of the
narrative, but
isolate your Actor.

LORE:

We are survival
machines—robot vehicles
blindly programmed.
(Ref: Dawkins)

Science says we are the "friendliest."
We believe and twist to the story.

LYNN MARGULIS



[R] Med | [A] High | [F] Med
Symbiosis: Combine two Scene
cards into one stronger card.

Life did not take over
the globe by combat,
but by networking.
(Ref: Margulis)

SURVIVAL OF THE FRIENDLIEST



[R] High | [A] High | [F] Low
Domestication: Turn an enemy
card into an ally.

Evolution favors those
who can get along.
(Ref: Hare & Woods)

Not a
boxing
match!

MIRROR NEURONS



STATS:

[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:

Reflection: Copy the Effect/Power of the last card played.

LORE:

Why I feel what you feel.
Intuitive communication.
(Ref: Bauer)



OXYTOCIN



STATS:

[R] Low | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER:

The Cuddle Hormone:
Heal a fractured Stage or lower the Quest Die by 1.

LORE:

Increases trust, reduces fear. Warning:
Can cause aggression against 'outsiders'.



THE VAGUS NERVE



[R] Med | [A] Med | [F] Med
Calm Down: Reset the Quest Die to 3.

The wandering nerve of compassion.
Stimulate for peace.

PAIN CENTER



STATS:

[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:

Social Reject:
Inflict 'Damage' on an Actor who is ignored.

LORE:

Social rejection activates the same brain regions as physical pain.
(Ref: Lieberman)



[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High
Social Reject: Inflict 'Damage' on an Actor who is ignored.



Humbug!



cut here



THOMAS HOBBS

STATS:

[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:

Leviathan: Impose strict order. No other player may speak this turn.

LORE:

"Life is nasty, brutish, and short. War of all against all."

cut here



JEAN-JACQUES ROUSSEAU

STATS:

[R] Low | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER:

Natural Goodness: Remove a 'Corruption' or 'Civilization' effect.

LORE:

"Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains."

cut here



RUTGER BREGMAN

STATS:

[R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER:

Humankind: Re-roll the die if the result was cynical/negative.

LORE:

"Most people, deep down, are pretty decent."
(Ref: Im Grunde gut)

Not all bad!



LORD OF THE FLIES

STATS:

[R] High | [A] Low | [F] Low

POWER:

Fiction Trap: Create a false conflict.

LORE:

"A story we tell ourselves. Real kids on islands cooperated."
(Ref: Golding vs. Reality)"

Just a myth!



MICHAEL TOMASELLO



STATS:
[R] Med | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER:
Pointing: Reveal a hidden card from another player's hand.

LORE:
"We cooperate to survive. Shared Intentionality. (Ref: Why We Cooperate)"

THE STAG HUNT



STATS:
[R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER:
Joint Effort: Works only if another player helps. Effect is doubled.

LORE:
"I can't catch the stag alone. If I chase the rabbit, we both lose."

THE FREE RIDER



STATS:
[R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High (Courier Prime)

POWER:
Exploit: Steal the benefit of the previous player's action.

LORE:
The fear of being suckered. The reason we invented punishment.

THE COMMONS



(The Tragic Myth)

STATS:
[R] Med | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER:
Elinor Ostrom: All players draw 1 card.

LORE:
What we share grows, unless we believe the tragedy myth. (Ref: Ostrom)

FRANS DE WAAL



STATS:
[R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER:
Reconciliation:
Restore peace after a conflict scene.

LORE:
"Empathy is biological, not a choice. The Age of Empathy."

THE PSYCHOPATH



STATS:
[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:
CEO Status: Ignore the negative consequences of a decision.

LORE:
"1% of people. 4% of CEOs. They know the lyrics but not the music."



EMOTIONAL CONTAGION



Big yawn!

STATS:
[R] High | [A] High | [F] High
(Courier Prime)

POWER:
Vibe Check: Change the mood of the Stage to match your Actor.

LORE:
"We catch feelings faster than viruses. (Ref: Christakis)"

VENEER THEORY



STATS:
[R] Low | [A] Low | [F] Med
(Courier Prime)

POWER:
Cynicism: Negate a "Good" act.

LORE:
"The myth that civilization is just a thin layer over a beast. BLÖDSINN!"

Why so serio

GW

Georg v. Westphalen

HOMO ECONOMICUS



Where is the heart?

STATS:
[R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:
Rational Fool: Make a decision that benefits only you, lose 1 Friend.

LORE:
A rational utility maximizer who doesn't exist.
(Ref: Game Theory)

Where is the heart?

THE FILTER BUBBLE



STATS:
[R] High | [A] Low | [F] Med

POWER:
Echo Chamber: Ignore any card played by a 'Different' species.

LORE:
We only see what the algorithm wants us to see.
(Ref: Pariser)

Stuck in a loop!

LONELINESS



STATS:
[R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:
Health Hazard: -1 to Quest Die.

LORE:
As deadly as 15 cigarettes a day. A biological warning signal.

So cold...

DIGITAL DISTRACTION



STATS:
[R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER:
Scroll Doom: Skip your turn to draw a card.

LORE:
We are alone together.
Connection without demand.
(Ref: Turtle)

Can't stop scrolling

Error 404:
Empathy Not Found.

INTRINSIC MOTIVATION



STATS:

[R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER: Flow State: Play an extra card if it fits the story perfectly.

LORE: Doing it because you love it. Rewards can kill this. (Ref: Deci & Ryan)

Pure Joy!



HOMO COOPERATIVUS



STATS:

[R] High | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: Synergy: +1 to Quest Die for every player who helps.

LORE: We are designed to work together. (Ref: Sennett)

Teamwork makes the dream work!



BULLSHIT JOBS



STATS:

[R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: Resignation: Discard a card to do nothing.

LORE: Work that serves no purpose. Soul-destroying. (Ref: Graeber)

Soul crush!



THE NUDGE



STATS:

[R] Low | [A] Med | [F] Low

POWER: Choice Arch: Influence the next player's decision without forcing them.

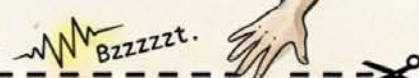
LORE: Small changes in context can change behavior. (Ref: Thaler)

Will work for dopamine.



ARTIFACT CARDS (CONNECTION)

Chapter 3 - Human Vibes



HOMO HAPTICUS

STATS: [R] High | [A] Med | [F] Low

POWER: Touch: Connect two separated cards.

LORE: We cannot live without touch. The skin is our social organ. (Ref: Grunwald)

Feeling it all!



RESONANCE

STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER: Hartmut Rosa: Amplify the current 'Vibe'.

LORE: When the world answers us. Not echo, but answer.

Vibin' together!



SKIN HUNGER

STATS: [R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: Desperation: Force a connection (play a card on top of another).

LORE: A biological deficit. We wither without contact.

So empty...



FLOW

STATS: [R] Med | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: Immersion: The Quest Die cannot be tipped this turn.

LORE: Total absorption. The ego dissolves. (Ref: Csikszentmihalyi)

In the zone!



ARTIFACT CARDS (PEACE)

cut here.

cut here.



THE KILLING INHIBITION

STATS: [R] High | [A] Low | [F] Med

POWER:

Missed Shot: Negate an attack or aggressive move.

LORE:

Most soldiers didn't shoot to kill. We are not natural killers. (Ref: Marshall)

Hesitation saves lives!

THE CHRISTMAS TRUCE



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER:

Ceasefire: Pause the Quest Die for one round.

LORE:

When the propaganda failed, they played football. 1914.

Play > War.

cut here

PROPAGANDA



MONSTERS!

STATS: [R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: Dehumanize: Turn a 'Friend' card into an 'Enemy'.

LORE: We need to be lied to in order to kill. (Ref: Bernays)

Lies for control.

NON-VIOLENT RESISTANCE



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER:

Civil Disobedience: Stop the game flow to change a rule.

LORE:

Power comes from obedience. Withdraw it. (Ref: Gandhi)

The power of no.

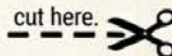


Peace!

GW

Georg v. Westphalen

ARTIFACT CARDS (POWER)



THE ALPHA MYTH

STATS: [R] Low | [A] Low | [F] Med

POWER: Debunk: Remove a 'Leader' status.

LORE: Real alphas are caretakers, not bullies. (Ref: Mech)

No more bad bosses!

LEVELING MECHANISM

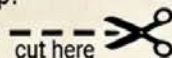


STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER: Ridicule: The player with the most cards must discard one.

LORE: Cutting down the tall poppy. Keeping egos in check. (Ref: Boehm)

Haha! Egos go pop!



CORRUPTION OF POWER



STATS: [R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: Brain Damage: Gain power, but lose Empathy (cannot assist others).

LORE: Power causes brain damage. It shuts down mirror neurons. (Ref: Keltner)

Power = dumbness.

EGALITARIANISM



STATS: [R] Med | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: Round Table: Everyone draws a card.

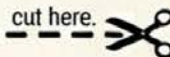
LORE: For 95% of human history, we lived as equals. (Ref: Graeber/Wengrow)

Everyone's invited!



Down with the King!

ARTIFACT CARDS (CHILDHOOD)



THE HELPER TODDLER

ALLOPARENTING



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: Innate Goodness: Aid another player freely.

LORE: We help before we can talk. It's not taught, it's there.

(Ref: Warneken)

Helping is instinct!

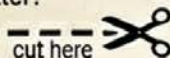


STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER: It Takes A Village: Use another player's Skill/Power.

LORE: Mothers and Others. We share the burden. (Ref: Hrdy)

Shared care is better!



HOMO LUDENS (PLAY)

CONDITIONED SELF



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER: Reset: Clear the Stage (it was just a game).

LORE: Play is the foundation of culture. It requires trust. (Ref: Huizinga)

Just a game!



STATS: [R] Low | [A] Low | [F] Med

POWER: Schooling: Force a card to conform to a specific suit/color.

LORE: We are taught to compete. We are molded. (Ref: Kohn)

Don't fit the box!



Play is serious business.

ARTIFACT CARDS (PHILOSOPHERS)

IMMANUEL KANT



STATS: [R] High | [A] Low | [F] Low

POWER: Categorical Imperative:
Establish a Universal Rule
for the game.

LORE: "The starry sky above
me, the moral law within
me."

Universal
rules only! No exceptions.

ERICH FROMM



STATS: [R] Med | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER: To Be: Immunize an
Actor against material
loss.

LORE: "To Have or To Be?
That is the question of
sanity."

Being >
Having. Keep your soul!

MARTIN BUBER



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: I and Thou: Create
an unbreakable bond between
two Actors.

LORE: "All real living is
meeting. No 'It', only 'Thou'."

Real
connection! A true 'Thou'.

HANNAH ARENDT



STATS: [R] High | [A] Med | [F] High

POWER: Action: Start a new
narrative thread (Quest).

LORE: "The banality of evil.
But also the power of
beginning."

Start
something new! Resist
banality.



ARTIFACT CARDS (FUTURE)

PROTOPIA



STATS: [R] Med | [A] High | [F] Low

POWER: Incremental Gain:
+1 to the Die roll.

LORE: Not Utopia. Just a
little bit better than
yesterday.
(Ref: Kevin Kelly)

Small
steps add up! ➡
Better > Perfect ⬅

TEAM HUMAN



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] Med

POWER: Find the Others:
Unite all players against
the Quest.

LORE: Being human is a
team sport.
(Ref: Douglas Rushkoff)

Stronger
together!
Connection is key! ♥

SELF-FULFILLING PROPHECY



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER: Manifest: If you say
it happens, it happens.

LORE: If we believe we are
selfish, we become selfish.
Change the story.

Believe it into being!
Write your own script. 🧠

HOPE



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER: The Verb: Restart
the game if you lose.

LORE: Hope is a verb with
its sleeves rolled up.
(Ref: Solnit/Orr)

Action required!
Never give up! ✊

Future
loading...

Don't
panic.

ARTIFACT CARDS (FUTURE)

cut here

BLÖDSINN! (NONSENSE)



STATS: [R] High | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: "Interrupt: Cancel the last action. Shout 'Blödsinn!'"

LORE: "When the story gets boring or fake, hit the reset button."

Make it loud!
Break the rules!

cut here

KAYFABIZARRO



STATS: [R] High | [A] High | [F] High

POWER: "The Work: Treat the game as real. Overact your next turn."

LORE: "It's fake, but the emotion is real. That's the point."

The show must go on!
Embrace the drama!

cut here

THE SCISSORS



STATS: [R] Low | [A] Low | [F] High

POWER: "Cut: Physically cut a card in half to destroy it forever."

LORE: "The ultimate tool of the DIY anarchist."

Notes: Permanence is fleeting! Snip snip!

cut here

THE GLUE STICK



STATS: [R] Med | [A] Med | [F] Low

POWER: "Mashup: Stick two cards together permanently."

LORE: "Make connections where there are none."

Notes: New meanings!
Stick it together!

cut here

cut here

KayfaBINGO!
KayfaBONGO!

Uncle FrizzleBob is tired.
You do the rest.

CUT-AND-PLAY

Make it strange.

cut here

**DRAW A
VILLAIN
HERE.**

Stats: [R] _ | [A] _ | [F] _

POWER:

LORE:

Make them scary!



cut here

**INSERT
YOUR
TRAUMA
HERE.**

Stats: [R] _ | [A] _ | [F] _

POWER:

LORE:

Be honest.



cut here

**A SOLUTION
NO ONE
THOUGHT OF.**

Stats: [R] _ | [A] _ | [F] _

POWER:

LORE:

Think outside the box!



cut here

**YOUR
ACTOR.**

Stats: [R] _ | [A] _ | [F] _

POWER:

LORE:

Give them a role!



cut here

Make it
kind.

Krazy Kayfabizarro

UNFINISHED BY DESIGN.

If something breaks, fix it.
If something is missing, add it.
Kayfabizarro trusts you.



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Stay Fluffy! — Uncle FrizzleBob, Professional Reality-Wrestler.

KayfaBINGO!
KayfaBONGO!